BLOOD ON THE PIR PANJAL

On June 9, as the Modi 3.0 cabinet in Delhi prepared for its oath-taking ceremony, three foreign terrorists opened fire on a bus carrying Hindu pilgrims in Reasi district of Jammu and Kashmir, killing nine and injuring 41. The incident was followed by three more terrorist acts in the Jammu region, raising alarm ahead of the Amarnath Yatra

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS** / *Text by* **MOAZUM MOHAMMAD**



1 5.30 PM
The bus ferrying 50 people, including the driver and conductor, sets out for Katra, 80 km from Ransoo–the base camp from where pilgrims trek 3.5 km to reach the Shiv Khori temple

2 6.10 PM
The bus, barely 10 km from Ransoo, reaches an isolated curve near Kanda village in the Taryath area. Three terrorists descend from the hill and appear on the road. One of them opens fire at the front of the bus and the other two provide covering fire

3 The driver is killed and the bus loses control, falling into a gorge. The terrorists continue firing indiscriminately at the vehicle from multiple directions till they are convinced the pilgrims are dead